Westbrook Planning Board

~ Planning Board Meeting ~

Date: Tuesday, July 7, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1207922359
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_07072026-1014

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *The applicant for 146 Bridge St. (TFS Limited) withdrew that application before the meeting began; it is not covered here. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

New Business

26-000401 — Site Plan, Subdivision, Conditional Use — Millbrook Estates, 300 East Bridge St. [3:27]

Discussion Summary

Tyler Nord (Westbrook Development Corporation) recapped the project last workshopped June 2: two mirrored, three-story, 36-unit all-one-bedroom affordable senior buildings at the existing Millbrook Estates complex, funded through Maine Housing's LIHTC program. Approval positions the project to apply for funding this fall (decision around November), with groundbreaking on the first building possible as early as fall 2027.

Responding to a question from the June 2 workshop about a possible earlier promise of no further development on this site, City Planner Rebecca Spitella reported staff found no such documented promise in the 1990/1992/2015 approval history; the site's zoned density has simply increased over time (100 units in 1990, +40 via a 2014 amendment, +72 via the 2024 amendment that enabled this project).

Member Nancy Litrocapes asked about a vague staff comment on reducing salt usage given the site's watershed location; staff and Nord explained this is a sustainability-coordinator priority rather than a hard requirement, addressed through pre/post-construction coordination. Vice Chair Turcotte reiterated support for the project's scale-reduction design choices. Chair McWilliams gave an extended statement maintaining the opposition he said he's held since the original 2024 review (correcting the applicant's recollection that the first vote was unanimous), citing neighborhood-scale concerns, while crediting the applicant for preserving mature trees along East Bridge Street planted by his own father-in-law.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 3–1 by roll call (Litrocapes, Schrage, and Turcotte in favor; McWilliams opposed; Tannenbaum and Axelson recused), moved by John Turcotte, seconded by Lucas Schrage.

Action Items

None.

Workshop — 3 Saunders Way, Bill Dodge Kia (26-000527)

Dealership Renovation/Expansion & Unresolved Multi-Lot Sign Question [21:58]

Discussion Summary

Dustin Roma (DM Roma Consulting Engineers) presented a renovation and rebranding of the existing Kia dealership (built 1998, expanded 2000): a 2,160-sq-ft service-area addition and a 3,850-sq-ft showroom addition, updated facade and signage, and elimination of a steep, heavily-salted driveway ramp in favor of stairs. The site already exceeds the Gateway Commercial District's maximum impervious coverage (90% currently), maintained as a legal nonconformity while adding compensating landscaped area around the new additions.

An unresolved question: this property is one of three Bill Dodge dealership lots the city currently treats as a single tax parcel, and the applicant is seeking clarity on whether signage standards (one freestanding sign per lot) apply individually or combined — legally nonconforming extra signs can only remain via panel swap, not full replacement, once that status is lost. Staff also asked the applicant to explore stormwater quality improvements given the site's location in the impaired Nason's Brook watershed.

Members Robin Tannenbaum and Nancy Litrocapes asked about landscaping plans given the exceeded impervious coverage; staff confirmed the lot-count determination won't change that math. Vice Chair Turcotte asked for more detail on the sign ordinance (one freestanding sign per lot, two building-mounted per tenant per facade, no variances permitted). Chair McWilliams asked how stormwater quality is measured; staff described MS4-permit reporting for larger qualifying projects (this one doesn't meet that threshold) plus periodic city sampling at specific outfalls.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — workshop item.

Action Items

None.

Workshop — Rock Row Buildings Y & YB (26-000529)

Office/Retail Building & 12 Nason's Brook-Facing Townhomes [39:15]

Discussion Summary

Ian McKim (Jones & Beach Engineers) and Amanda (Aero Street/spacecraft) presented the next individual Rock Row Phase 3 site plan: Building Y, a two-story office-over-retail building at the Rock Row Boulevard/Quarry Drive corner, and Building YB, twelve three-story townhomes with rear garages and brook-facing front doors/balconies, flanked by retail end caps. A shared driveway is sized for fire apparatus and occasional large deliveries, with a 20-foot dedicated fire lane kept clear of delivery traffic. The team expects to submit a consolidated state stormwater permit application for all of Phase 3 by month's end, anticipates approval around January/February 2027, and expects to bring final site plans back for a vote next spring.

Board reaction was strongly positive. Member Lucas Schrage praised the brook-facing design and asked about a previously floated heated-sidewalk option (under consideration, not yet committed). Member Robin Tannenbaum praised the townhomes' reduced scale, asked about guest parking (reliant on shared garage access agreements, no dedicated spaces), and asked about campus-wide rooftop solar (discussed often, not

currently in base designs). Member Nancy Litrocapes confirmed trash-truck frequency and brook-facing balconies, and raised a concern about dark facades staining from birds; the team noted a resident peregrine falcon in the quarry has suppressed local pigeon and seagull populations. Chair McWilliams confirmed ADA accessibility through the courtyard and trail network.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — workshop item.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names against the official Planning Board roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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